THE LONG LEDGER

CHAPTER 5

THE PLANTS CLOSE

1990s–2009

SEALED

Open only when the family begins this chapter.

The Long Ledger · Chapter 5: The Plants Close (1990s–2009)

GM's Moraine plant closes in 2008; NCR leaves in 2009. Before the crash, the brokers came door to door with teaser rates and cash-out refinances. Now the temp agency is the only one hiring.

Setup

Set up the Full Block (Co-op). Swap the Housing and Labor deal decks for this envelope's era decks (the cards with “The Plants Close” backs; print the backs on the reverse so era deals never mix into the base deck). Start Labor at Squeeze 2. Everyone starts with 1 Trust. The Owner is The Algorithm: slide its card face-down under the board instead of shuffling the Owners. Ignore the scenario deck. If the family played the last chapter: put on the district stickers (each Rebuilt takes 1 Squeeze off a district this chapter starts squeezed, or else adds Clarity 1; each Scarred adds Squeeze 1), and if that chapter was lost the community rallies: everyone +1 Trust. Then apply last chapter's Family Decision (Voice): Run for office: In Chapter 5, the Owner's hidden hand rests for the first 3 rounds. Keep organizing: In Chapter 5, the Organizer starts with 5 Trust.

The twist

Labor starts at Squeeze 2 and everyone starts with 1 Trust. Before the chapter the family chooses: defend what you built (the Machine strikes your Rebuilt districts first) or let one go (remove one Rebuilt sticker).

Defend or let go

Decide before round 1, together. Defend: in every Machine phase, strike your Rebuilt districts first. Let go: peel one Rebuilt sticker off now; the Machine strikes as usual.

The Owner's face

The Algorithm: scoring, automation and risk models. Relentless: the Machine strikes one extra time every round.

Ending the chapter

Win or lose, fill in the Family Ledger on the lineage sheet: win +2 and +1 per awake district; lose −2 and −1 per captured district; each Fall −1 and each Reach +1. Awake districts heal a Scar or take a Rebuilt sticker; captured districts take a Scarred sticker (at most 2 per district). A chapter won with no Falls redeems one Fall from an earlier chapter (+2). History unlocked: “The People's Free Medical Clinics”. With a win, also “Greenwood: Black Wall Street”.

Family Decision

Sell the house at the bottom of the market, or hold on? Sell: In Chapter 6, everyone starts with +2 Trust, but Housing loses a Rebuilt sticker. Hold on: Housing keeps everything, and starts Chapter 6 with 1 more Squeeze.

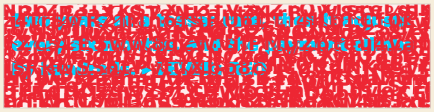
Balance-tested with computer players at 1–5 players (python3 balance_test.py, CAMPAIGNS and SOLO). Solo: 5 actions, Teach a neighbor, trace 2 threads (RULES.md, Solo).

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-01

WHAT YOU SEE — SIGN NOW · count 15

Refinance today and cut your payment way down! (2/28 loan)

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

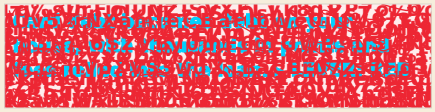
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-02

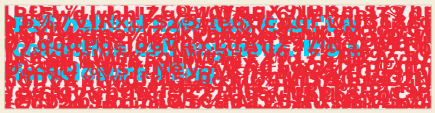
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Cash out your equity: pay off the cards and fix the kitchen too!

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-03

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

No pay stubs needed. We'll fill in the income for you. (Stated-income loan)

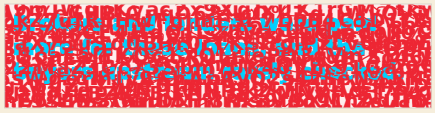
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-04

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Rates dropped again! Let's refinance and lower your payment.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-05

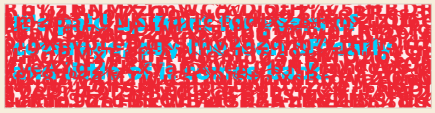
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Loan protection included, so your family is covered if something happens to you.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-06

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

You can always refinance later, once your credit is better.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

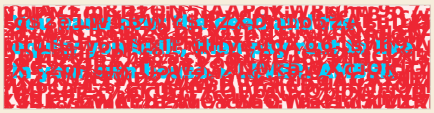
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-07

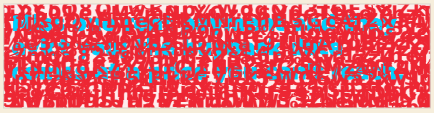
WHAT YOU SEE — SIGN NOW · count 15

Behind on the mortgage? Sign the deed over to us and we'll save your house.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-08

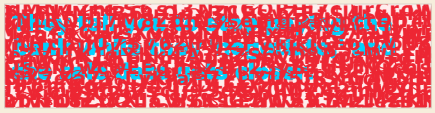
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

We'll get your bank to lower your payment. Just $1,500 up front.

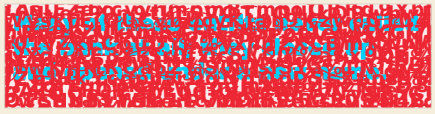
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-09

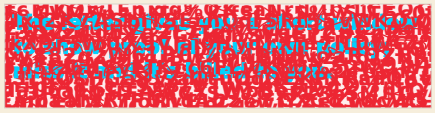
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Notice: your lender has bought insurance on your home for you.

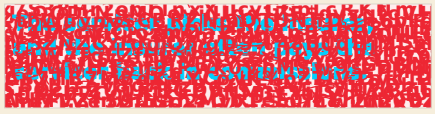
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

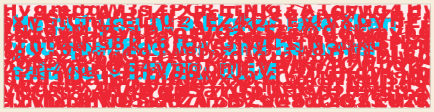
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-10

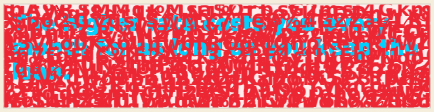
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Your broker shops every bank in town to get you the best rate.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-11

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Loans for folks with credit like yours. We specialize in this neighborhood.

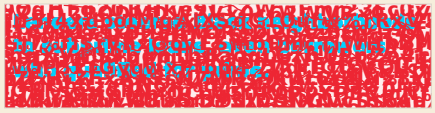
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-12

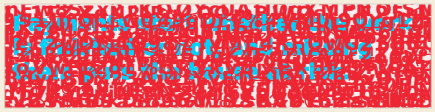
WHAT YOU SEE — SIGN NOW · count 15

We were just on your street: new furnace today, financing right at the door.

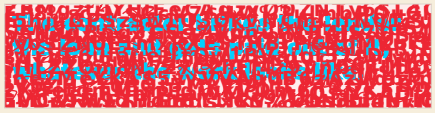
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

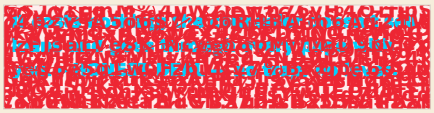
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-13

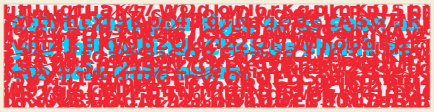
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Free housing counseling: a HUD-approved counselor reads the loan with you.

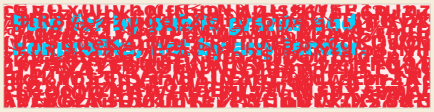
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-14

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

The credit union: refinance into a fixed rate you can actually afford.

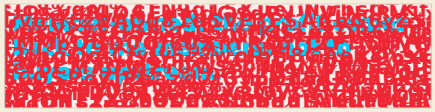
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

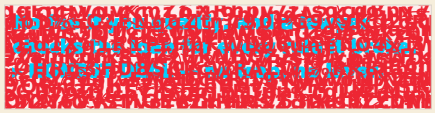
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

HOUSING THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM HOU-15

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Legal aid will fight the foreclosure with you, for free.

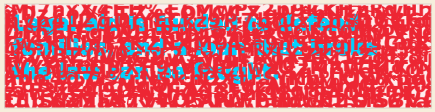
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

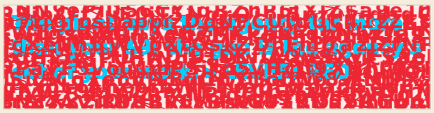
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-01

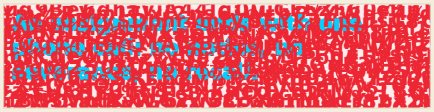
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Staffing agency: $9 an hour at the parts plant, start tomorrow.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

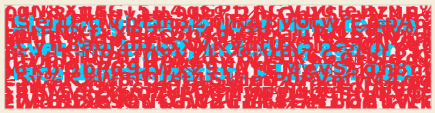
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-02

WHAT YOU SEE — SIGN NOW · count 15

Here's your severance check. Just sign the release first, today.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

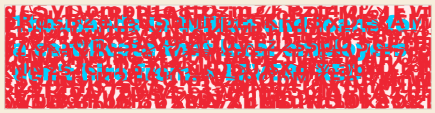
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-03

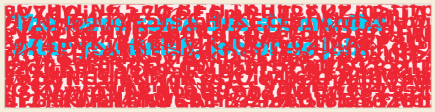
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Retrain for a new career. Your severance covers the tuition!

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-04

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Keep your 401(k) in company stock. Nobody knows this company like you do.

● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

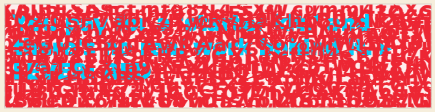
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-05

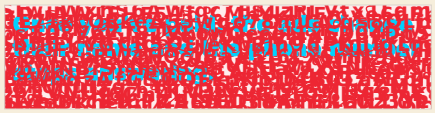
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Work from home: stuff envelopes and earn $500 a week!

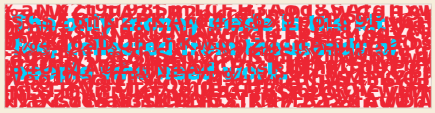
● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

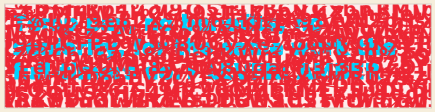
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-06

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Temp-to-hire: work hard and they'll bring you on full time!

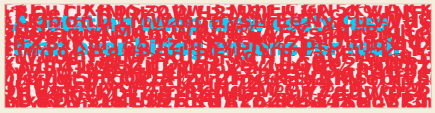
● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-07

WHAT YOU SEE — SIGN NOW · count 15

Take the voluntary buyout now. This offer won't be this good again.

● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

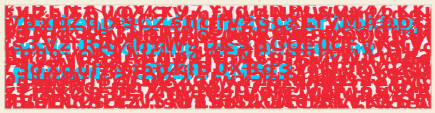
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-08

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

No layoffs are planned. Keep showing up and don't listen to rumors.

● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

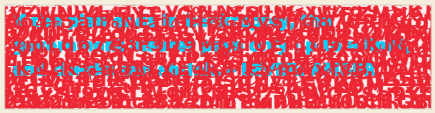
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-09

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Your pension is safe for life. Don't worry about the bankruptcy.

● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-10

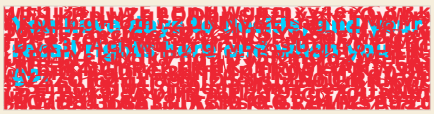
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

The new plant down south is hiring. Move with the company!

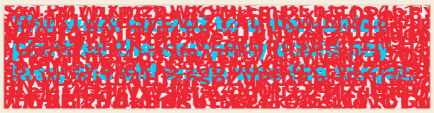
● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-11

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Take the concessions and the plant stays open. Sign the new contract.

● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-12

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Free retirement seminar for laid-off workers, right here at the hall.

● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

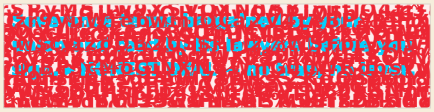
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-13

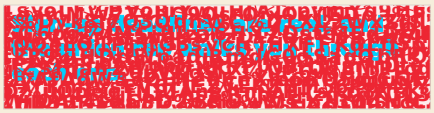
WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1990s–2009

The union's deal: severance, health coverage, and a job center that places people.

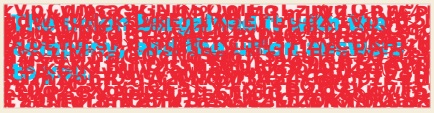
● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

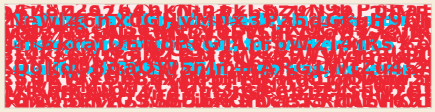
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-14

WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1990s–2009

Trade Adjustment Assistance: training and income help if trade cost your job.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR THE PLANTS CLOSE · FORM LAB-15

WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1990s–2009

The community college's program, built with a hospital that's hiring.

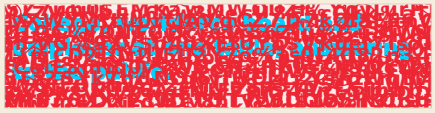
● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

THE OWNER hidden

The Algorithm

The Algorithm: scoring, automation and risk models. Relentless: the Machine strikes one extra time every round.

This chapter's Owner. Slide it face-down under the board instead of shuffling the Owners.

THE TWIST Chapter 5

The Plants Close

Labor starts at Squeeze 2 and everyone starts with 1 Trust. Before the chapter the family chooses: defend what you built (the Machine strikes your Rebuilt districts first) or let one go (remove one Rebuilt sticker).

DEFEND OR LET GO before round 1

What We Built

Decide before round 1, together. Defend: in every Machine phase, strike your Rebuilt districts first. Let go: peel one Rebuilt sticker off now; the Machine strikes as usual.

Defend: ☐ Let go of: _____

FAMILY DECISION after the chapter

Sell the house at the bottom of the market, or hold on?

Sell: In Chapter 6, everyone starts with +2 Trust, but Housing loses a Rebuilt sticker. Hold on: Housing keeps everything, and starts Chapter 6 with 1 more Squeeze.

THE COMMUNITY RALLIES after a loss

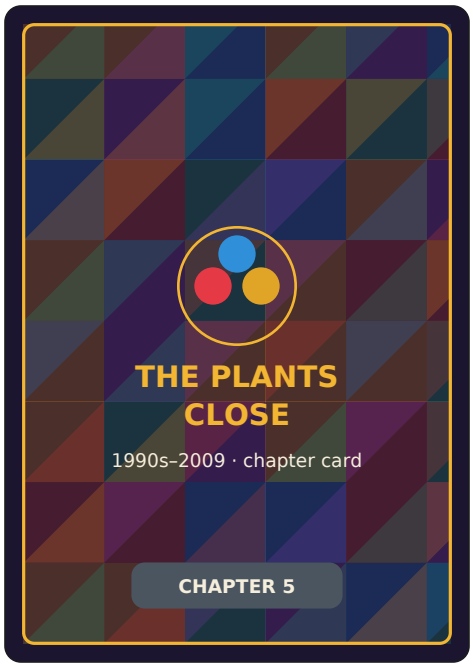
The Block Shows Up

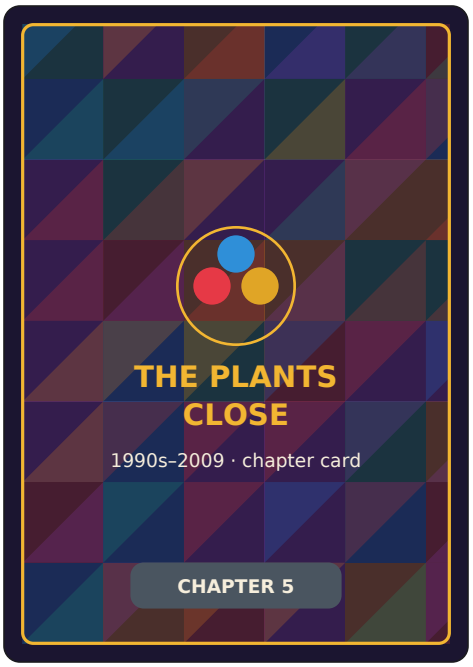
If the last chapter was lost: everyone starts this chapter with +1 Trust. The church, the club and the neighbors show up.

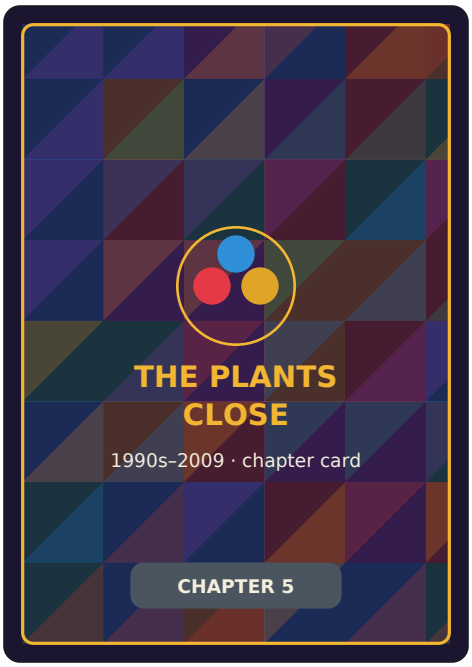
LEDGER reference

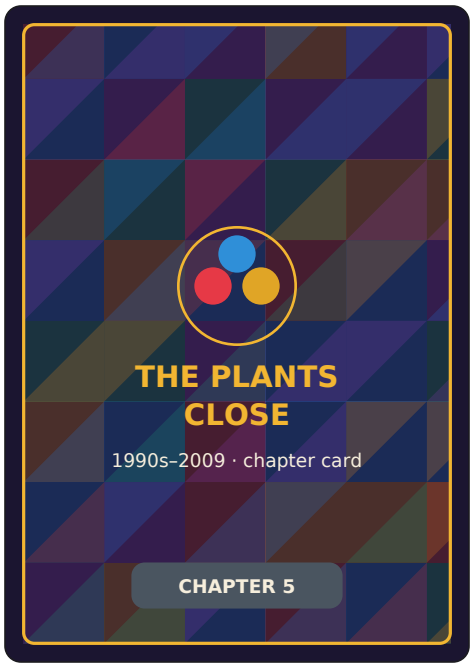
Scoring the Chapter

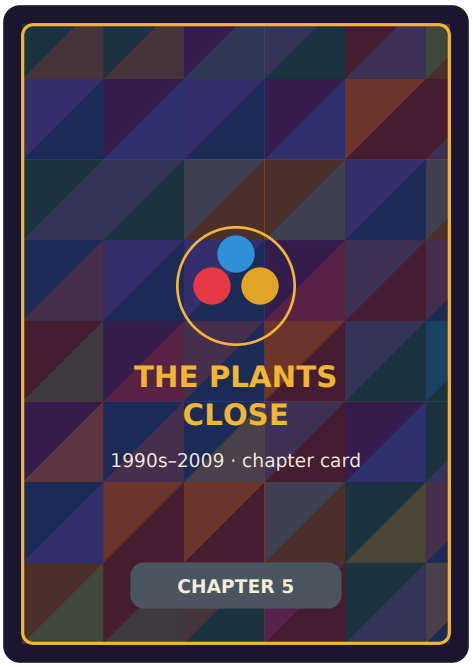
Win +2, +1 per awake district. Lose −2, −1 per captured district. Each Fall −1, each Reach +1. Awake: heal a Scar, else Rebuilt. Captured: Scarred. Max 2 stickers per district.

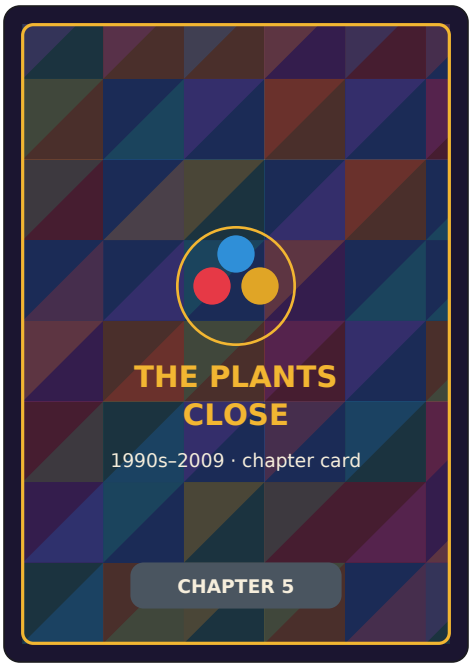

THE PLANTS CLOSE
1990s–2009 · chapter card
CHAPTER 5

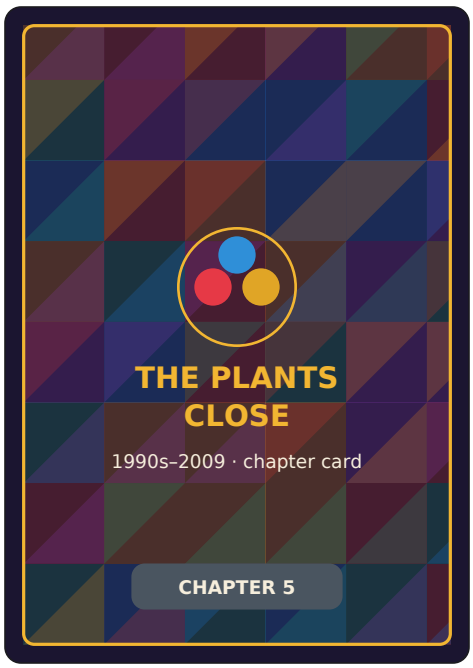

THE PLANTS CLOSE
1990s–2009 · chapter card
CHAPTER 5

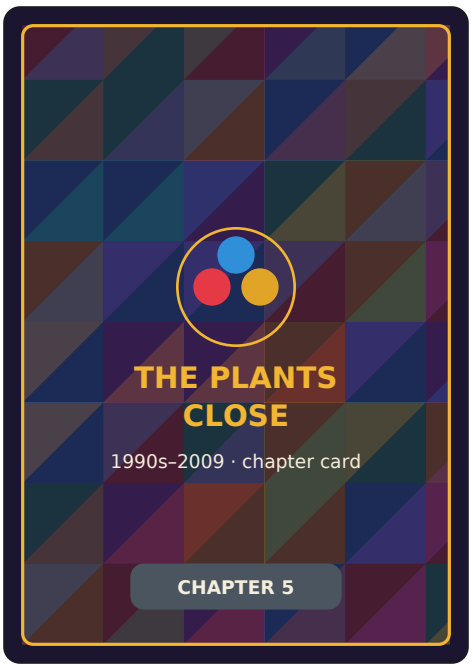

THE PLANTS CLOSE
1990s–2009 · chapter card
CHAPTER 5

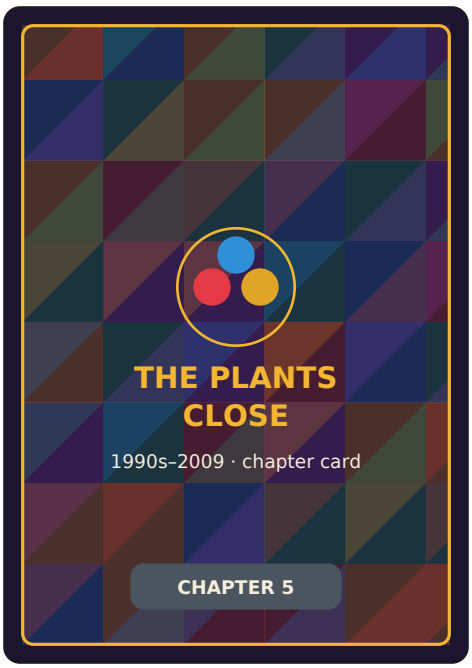

THE PLANTS CLOSE
1990s–2009 · chapter card
CHAPTER 5


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